

BrightHire: Charting a singular path in a crowded category

By Ayman Kotob

Slide 1: Cover

BrightHire: Charting a singular path in a crowded category

By Ayman Kotob (include headshot)

Slide 2: AI Disclosure

This presentation was created by Ayman Kotob with assistance from the following AI tools: Claude and Claude Code. The work was divided as follows:

Ayman:

- Performed initial exploratory research on AI and HRtech landscape, including competitors
- Reviewed BrightHire website to understand current offerings
- Generated narrative flow of this document
- Reviewed AI outputs

AI tools:

- Reviewed drafts to identify opportunities for improvement
 - Built out slides based on content Ayman developed
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Section divider: Customers

Slide 3: BrightHire speaks to several stakeholders in the interview interaction

Talent Acquisition professionals

Who they are: Tip of the spear sourcing and screening talent

What they are looking to do: Fill the applicant top-of-the-funnel with the most qualified candidates

Why is this hard: Large volume of applicants (more than their bandwidth), increased use of AI makes it harder to separate actual qualifications from buzzwords, doing too many things at once (interviewing, taking notes, corralling folks for feedback) inevitably means something has to give and quality will suffer

Hiring managers

Who they are: Leaders for specific function in their org

What they are looking to do: Fill positions on their teams

Why is this hard: Have their day jobs to take care of so they don't have time to prepare for interviews and provide thorough feedback, potentially fractious relationship with recruiting team if no clear alignment/communication on needs

People and HR leaders

Who they are: C-suite execs that oversee hiring and talent strategy of organization

What they are looking to do: Develop structured, clear, and defensible practices to secure the best talent for their organization

Why is this hard: Lack of consistency in processes, teams lack the tools to capture interview moments

Candidates

Who they are: Job seekers

What they are looking to do: Get a real shot at demonstrating their fit for desired jobs, clear feedback for improvement if they don't, a human experience, no ghosting

Why is this hard: High-volume of applications means it is really hard to land initial interviews and they get screened out by ATS, overworked TA professionals means inconsistent communication, potential ghosting, and lack of feedback

Section divider: The Moment

Slide 4: Hiring is in an AI doom loop

The talent acquisition landscape is at one of the most strained moments in its history — and it plays directly to BrightHire's strengths.

- Volume crisis. Greenhouse processed 300 million applications in a single year. Recruiters are managing triple the volume per role with no headcount growth.

- AI on both sides of the table. 40–80% of candidates use AI to apply. 13% used generative AI in real-time during their interview (Gartner, Q3 2025).
- Trust has collapsed. Only 8% of job seekers think AI screening is fair. 26% trust AI to evaluate them. 53% were ghosted in 2026. Greenhouse's CEO publicly called it "the AI doom loop."

The takeaway: The answer to the doom loop isn't less AI. It's better AI applied to the right moment — the interview itself, where signal lives and trust can be rebuilt.

Section divider: Challenge

Slide 5: A crowded market — and what BrightHire has to defend against

Vs. similar players (like Metaview)

Threat: Pivoting from notetaker to multi-agent platform "sourcing to offer"

BrightHire's counter: They're sprinting wide; BrightHire goes deep on the one workflow that decides quality of hire — the interview itself

Vs. ATSs moving upstream (Greenhouse, Ashby, Employ)

Threat: Well-funded systems of record for candidates buying into interview tooling (Ezra, Talent Llama, Pillar)

BrightHire's counter: Three structural defenses — depth ATSs won't invest in, ATS-agnostic across multi-ATS enterprises, and 3M+ interviews of compounding training data

Vs. generic notetakers (Fireflies, Otter, Fathom, Zoom AI Companion)

Threat: Capture is becoming free

BrightHire's counter: They record conversations. BrightHire structures them — and turns them into auditable decisions

Vs. the old way

Threat: Manual screening, vibes-based hiring

BrightHire's counter: AI screening at scale, fully engaged interviewers, decisions grounded in evidence not memory

Section divider: Narrative

Slide 6: BrightHire's narrative — the system of record for hiring decisions

The way BrightHire wins in this crowded market is by claiming the one position no competitor can credibly own: the system of record for hiring decisions. An ATS holds the candidate record. A notetaker holds the transcript. Only BrightHire holds the structured, auditable link between the conversation and the decision — which is the part that actually matters when leadership asks "why did we hire this person?"

Three things make this claim defensible:

End-to-end. Most competitors are point solutions — capture only, screening only, or scheduling only. BrightHire spans the full interview workflow: Plan → Screen → Interview → Capture → Decide → Improve. That's the system of record's shape. Covers every side of the interview. Because the platform spans the full workflow, it serves every stakeholder — TA gets screening and capture, hiring managers get structure and clarity, people leaders get defensible processes, candidates get a real shot and real feedback. No competitor serves all four.

Purpose-built, with proof. Six years of building AI for this specific function. 3M+ real interviews of training data — a corpus no generic notetaker, no ATS feature team, and no recently-pivoted competitor can match. The AI gets better at interviews specifically, every quarter.

Slide 7: BrightHire positioning statement

BrightHire is the system of record for hiring decisions — the end-to-end interview intelligence platform purpose-built to turn every conversation into structured, fair evidence. So recruiters move faster, candidates get the experience they deserve, and every hire is a decision you can defend.

Section divider: What I'd do first

Slide 8: Where I'd start — the first 90 days

1. Rewrite the homepage hero around the system-of-record claim. The current "AI built for exceptional hiring" is generic enough that any competitor could use it. Lead with the

category claim, surface the AI doom loop data above the fold, and visually separate customer logos from integration logos to stop diluting both signals.

2. Build the proof the claim needs. A positioning claim is only as strong as the evidence underneath it. Specifically: multi-ATS enterprise case studies (the ATS-agnostic moat), interview-craft research published from the 3M-interview corpus (the data moat), and head-to-head depth comparisons vs. Metaview and Ashby (the depth moat).

3. Get ahead of the Zoom narrative. The Zoom acquisition is distribution upside and positioning risk. Build a permanent "BrightHire + Zoom" page that names the independent-brand story explicitly, plus a /compare/zoom-ai-companion page — because Metaview already has one, and buyers will ask the question regardless of whether we answer it.